FREE PLAYBOOK · LEAD GENERATION

Find buyers on every platform. Reach them on more than one.





A practical playbook for founders and sales teams: where buyers ask for help online, the signals that say now is a good time to reach out, and how to run multi-channel campaigns that turn a name into a real conversation.

- 7 platforms mapped
- 40 buying-intent phrases
- 8 timing signals
- 2 ready-made cadences
- 7 message templates
- Deliverability checklist

AGENT 01 · SOCIAL LISTENING

Finds the people already asking

Reads conversations across seven platforms every day and brings you the posts where someone wants what you sell, with a reply and a DM drafted.

AGENT 02 · AI SDR

Finds the buyers who fit, and follows up

Finds companies that match your ideal customer, checks for a reason to talk now, writes to each one and sends every follow-up on time.

WHY LEAD GENERATION STALLS

Most lead lists fail for one of three reasons.

Most businesses find leads in one of two ways: they wait for buyers to find them, or they send a batch of cold emails and hope. Both leave money on the table, and almost always for the same three reasons.

REASON 01

Wrong people

Lists built from a job title alone. They fit on paper but have no reason to care about you today.

REASON 02

Wrong time

A good fit on a bad week. Without a timing signal you are guessing, and most guesses land when nobody is buying.

REASON 03

One touch

A single email in a crowded inbox. Many people who would have said yes never saw it, or saw it on the wrong day.

THE FIX, IN ONE LINE

Find people who fit and have a reason to talk now, then show up in more than one place until the timing is right.

HOW THIS PLAYBOOK FITS TOGETHER

SOURCE A · WARM

People asking

Someone posts "can anyone recommend…" on Reddit, LinkedIn or X. Covered in chapters 02 and 04.

SOURCE B · FIT + SIGNAL

People who match, at the right moment

A company that fits is hiring, raised money or just launched. Covered in chapter 03.

→

CHAPTERS 05 TO 07

A multi-channel campaign

Several useful touches across email, LinkedIn and the platform where they spoke up.

→

THE GOAL

A conversation

A reply, a call booked, a buyer who already knows your name.

INSIDE

02	Where buyers ask for help on 7 platforms, and a bank of 40 buying-intent phrases	06	Two ready-made 14-day cadences, step by step
03	8 timing signals for outbound, and how to rank leads by fit and timing	07	How the AI SDR agent runs outbound from setup to replies
04	How the social listening agent finds people asking, every day	08	7 message templates you can copy today
05	Why multi-channel campaigns raise your odds of a reply	09	A weekly scorecard and a deliverability checklist

SOURCE A · WARM LEADS

Every day, your buyers post the exact question you answer.

People ask their peers before they ask a salesperson. They post on LinkedIn, in subreddits, in Facebook groups and under YouTube videos. Find those posts on the day they go up and you are talking to someone who is already shopping.

PLATFORM	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT BUYERS POST	BEST FIRST MOVE
LinkedIn	Posts and comments in your niche, "recommendations" posts, posts by people your buyers follow	"Can anyone recommend a…" · "We're looking for a partner to…"	Comment with a useful answer. Connect afterwards with a note that mentions the post.
Reddit	Subreddits where your customers hang out, not where your competitors do	"What do you use for…" · "Is [product] worth it?"	Answer fully in the thread. Never pitch in a first reply; many subreddits ban it.
X	Search for phrases plus your topic, and replies to big accounts in your space	"Anyone know a good…" · "So frustrated with [tool]"	A short, specific reply. DM only once they engage back.
Threads	Topic tags and search for your category	Same questions as X, in a more casual voice	A friendly, conversational reply. Keep it brief.
YouTube	Comments under tutorials, reviews and "how I do X" videos in your field	"Does this work for…?" · "What would you use instead?"	Reply with one concrete tip. YouTube comments stay live for months.
Facebook	Groups for your customer's industry or location	"Who do you use for…" · "Need help with…"	Follow the group rules. Answer, then offer to share more by message.
Instagram	Comments on creators' posts in your niche, and niche hashtags	"How do you do this?" · "I need this"	Reply to the comment, then send a DM that mentions it.

RULE 01

Speed beats polish

A good answer in the first few hours gets seen. A perfect answer three days later is buried under twenty others.

RULE 02

Help first, sell later

Answer the question they asked. If your answer is good, they will look at who wrote it.

RULE 03

Follow the house rules

Every group and subreddit has its own. One spammy reply can get you banned from the place your buyers gather.

FIND YOUR COMMUNITIES IN 15 MINUTES

Ask your customers

Ask your three best customers where they go for advice. Their answers are your shortlist.

Follow the questions

Search your category plus "reddit" or "group". Note where the same questions keep coming up.

Keep the active ones

Keep places with new questions every week and real answers. Drop the ones full of promotion.

COPY THESE INTO ANY SEARCH BAR

40 buying-intent phrases, and the ones to filter out.

Pair each phrase with your category, for example `"recommend" + "bookkeeper"`. Swap the words in brackets for your product, your category or a competitor's name.

STAGE 01 · ASKING FOR A RECOMMENDATION

They know they need something

`can anyone recommend` `looking for a [category]` `who do you use for` `any suggestions for` `what's the best [category] for` `does anyone know a good` `recommendations for` `need help with` `where do I find a` `who should I hire for`

STAGE 02 · COMPARING OPTIONS

They are choosing between you and someone else

`[A] vs [B]` `alternative to [competitor]` `switching from [competitor]` `is [product] worth it` `thinking about trying` `pros and cons of` `has anyone used` `[competitor] review` `cheaper than [competitor]` `moving away from`

STAGE 03 · FEELING THE PAIN

They have the problem, maybe not the words

`struggling with` `sick of` `spending hours on` `there has to be a better way` `drowning in` `can't keep up with` `keeps breaking` `wasting so much time` `how do you all handle` `am I the only one who`

STAGE 04 · GETTING READY TO BUY

Budget, timing or a change is in motion

`budget for` `getting quotes for` `how much should I pay for` `setting up our first` `just raised` `scaling our` `about to launch` `new role, first 90 days` `outsourcing our` `time to replace`

FILTER THESE OUT · THEY LOOK LIKE BUYERS BUT ARE NOT

Self-promotion

`I help [X] do [Y]` `check out my` `link in bio`

Vendors pitching

`we offer` `DM me for` `use code`

Job posts

`we're hiring` `apply now` `[role] wanted`

Mentions of your topic are mostly other people selling. If you search by hand, expect to scroll past many of these for every real buyer. This filtering is the most tedious part of social listening, and the first part worth automating.

Try it in two minutes

Pick three phrases from Stage 01, add your category, and search them on Reddit and LinkedIn sorted by newest. Count the real buyers you find from the last 7 days. That is your baseline.

SOURCE B · FIT + SIGNAL

The best outbound opens on something true that happened this week.

Not everyone posts their problems. For outbound, look for companies that fit your ideal customer and have a visible reason to talk to you now. That reason becomes the first line of your email.

SIGNAL	WHERE TO SPOT IT	WHY IT MATTERS	OPEN WITH
Hiring for a role you support	Careers page, job boards, LinkedIn jobs	They have a gap and a budget right now	"Saw you're hiring two account managers…"
New funding	Press releases, funding databases, founder posts	New money usually comes with new targets	"Congrats on the round. Usually that means…"
New leader in the seat	LinkedIn job changes, company news	New leaders often review tools and suppliers early	"Congrats on the new role at [company]…"
Launch or new service	Website, product pages, press, social posts	Growth creates new work to handle	"Your new [service] looks great. One thing that…"
Team growth	Headcount changes, "we're growing" posts	Processes that worked at 10 people break at 30	"Your team has grown fast this year…"
New market or location	Announcements, new office pages, local listings	New ground means new suppliers	"Saw you've opened in [city]…"
Complaint about a current tool	Public posts, reviews, community threads	They are halfway out the door already	"Saw your post about [tool]. We hear that a lot…"
Engaging with your space	Comments on posts about your topic, event attendance	The topic is on their mind this week	"Saw your comment on [post]. Curious what…"

WHO TO CONTACT FIRST

	SIGNAL: YES	SIGNAL: NO
STRONG FIT	**Contact today** Your best leads. Full multi-channel cadence.	**Watch** Light touch now. Move up when a signal appears.
WEAK FIT	**Think twice** Only if the signal is very strong. Otherwise refer.	**Skip** Not worth a touch.

Write down your ideal customer in two sentences

Everything in this playbook gets easier once this is clear. Brief it the way you would brief a new hire:

- The kind of company, its size and where it is
- The person you want to reach, by role
- The problem they have that you solve
- The signals that say "now"

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Example: "Marketing agencies in the UK with 10 to 50 people. I want to reach the founder or MD, especially when they're hiring account managers or launching a new service."
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CHAPTER 02, DONE FOR YOU EVERY DAY

How the social listening agent finds people asking for you.

Searching seven platforms by hand, every day, is a part-time job. The social listening agent does the reading and the filtering, and hands you only the posts worth answering.



1
Describe who you want to reach
A sentence or two: who you help and the problem they post about.

2
It reads seven platforms
Reddit, X, Threads, YouTube, LinkedIn, Facebook and Instagram.

3
It skips the noise
Self-promotion, vendors pitching, job posts and off topic chatter.

4
It rates every match
Strong or good, so you answer the best ones first.

5
It drafts a reply and a DM
A helpful public answer, and a short message to take it private.

Found today EXAMPLE · LAST 24 HOURS

U/DESIGNDAILY_ IN R/FREELANCE · 12M — STRONG MATCH

"Tax time again and my receipts are a mess. What do you all use to track expenses?"

KAYLA M. ON X · 1H — STRONG MATCH

"Chasing three clients for unpaid invoices today. There has to be a better way than spreadsheets."

TOM REYES ON LINKEDIN · 3H — GOOD MATCH

"Two years freelancing and I still do my books in a spreadsheet. What should I switch to?"

SKIPPED TODAY: SELF-PROMOTION · VENDORS PITCHING · JOB POSTS · OFF TOPIC

Reply to u/designdaily_ DRAFTED

"Snap every receipt the day you get it and tag it by client. Doing it weekly instead of yearly turns tax time into a 20 minute job. Happy to share the categories I use if useful."

ANSWERS THE QUESTION FIRST · NO HARD SELL · SOUNDS LIKE YOU

DM, ready when they reply

"Hey, saw your post in r/freelance about receipts. I put together the exact setup I mentioned. Want me to send it over?"

WHY YOU PRESS SEND

Your name, your account, your call

The agent finds and drafts. You choose which to send, make any change you want and post from your own account. Platforms are wary of automated posting, and buyers can tell a bot. A human send keeps your accounts safe and your replies real.

WHAT IT REPLACES

Hours of scrolling, every week

- Checking seven platforms, every day, including the posts that went up overnight
- Wading through the sellers to find the one real buyer
- Writing every reply from scratch

Example posts and replies are illustrative. Your matches depend on your market and the people you describe.

THE CORE IDEA

One message is a lottery ticket. A multi-channel campaign is a plan.

A buyer who ignores one email is not saying no. Usually they are busy, they missed it, or the timing was off. Showing up a few times, in a few places, with something useful each time, is one of the most reliable ways to raise the odds that a good lead turns into a conversation.

REASON 01

More chances to be seen

Inboxes and feeds are crowded. Every touch in a different place is another chance to land on a day they are paying attention.

REASON 02

Familiar beats cold

The name they saw giving a helpful answer on Monday is not a stranger in their inbox on Wednesday. Recognition is the start of trust.

REASON 03

People have a favourite channel

Some live in email. Some only answer LinkedIn messages. Some reply to a comment but never a cold email. Multi-channel meets each one where they answer.

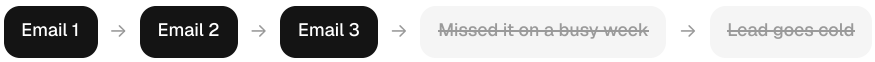
REASON 04

Timing changes week to week

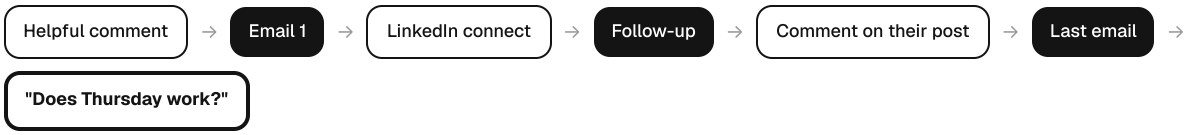
"Not now" in week one can become "good timing, actually" in week three. A campaign is still running when the moment arrives.

THE SAME LEAD, TWO WAYS

Single channel



Multi-channel



FOUR RULES THAT KEEP IT WELCOME, NOT ANNOYING

Every touch adds something

A tip, an example, a question. Never "just bumping this".

Never the same message twice

Each channel gets its own short, native message.

Stop the moment they reply

A reply, even "not now", ends the sequence. Then talk.

Keep social human

Comments and DMs sent by you, in your own words.

Results vary with your market, your list and your message. Track your own numbers with the scorecard in chapter 09.

COPY THESE STEP BY STEP

Two ready-made multi-channel cadences.

Use Play A when someone has asked a question in public. Use Play B when a company fits and shows a timing signal. Each touch says who does the work: AGENT runs it for you, AGENT DRAFTS means the agent writes it and you send it, YOU takes a minute or two.

PLAY A · START WARM

Someone asked for what you sell

Powered by the social listening agent

DAY	TOUCH	WHO
0	**Public reply** on the platform where they posted. Answer the question. No pitch.	AGENT DRAFTS
1	**DM** that mentions their post and offers one useful thing.	AGENT DRAFTS
3	**LinkedIn connect** with a note that mentions the thread.	YOU
5	**Engage** with their next post: a real comment, not a like.	YOU
7	**Second DM** with a resource or example tied to their question.	YOU
10	**Email**, if you have their work address and the company fits. Mention where you met.	YOU
14	**Close the loop** politely. Leave the door open.	YOU

PLAY B · START WITH A SIGNAL

A company that fits just gave you a reason

Powered by the AI SDR agent

DAY	TOUCH	WHO
1	**First email** opening on the signal. One clear, small ask.	AGENT
2	**LinkedIn**: view their profile and connect. No pitch in the note.	YOU
3	**Follow-up email**: a short nudge with one example.	AGENT
5	**Comment** on a recent post by them or their company.	YOU
7	**Last email** that closes the loop, politely.	AGENT
9	**LinkedIn message**, only if they accepted. Different angle from the emails.	YOU
14+	**Stay visible**: engage with their content now and then. Re-enter the cadence on a new signal.	YOU

A reply ends the sequence

The moment they answer anywhere, stop every scheduled touch and have a real conversation.

"Not now" is a date

Ask when to check back, note it and come back with something new. Not the same email again.

Keep your part small

With the agents finding leads and writing the messages, your part is a few minutes per lead.

CHAPTERS 03 AND 06, DONE FOR YOU

How the AI SDR agent runs outbound from setup to replies.

Setting it up is one brief: who you sell to, in a sentence or two. From there the agent does the work a sales development rep would, every morning, and the replies come to you.



1

You brief it once

Describe who you sell to, like briefing a new hire. Change it any time in plain English.

2

It finds who fits

Companies and people that match the customer you described.

3

It checks for "why now"

Hiring, funding, growth, new launches. And tells you why each lead fits.

4

It writes to each one

A personal email in your voice that opens on something true about their business.

5

It follows up, on time

Sends from your Gmail or Outlook on paid plans and lines up every follow-up.

Today's leads — EXAMPLE

Maya Collins — STRONG FIT
Founder, Northwind Creative
Why now: hiring 2 account managers

Daniel Okafor — STRONG FIT
Head of Growth, Brightside Media
Why now: launched a new service line

Priya Nair — GOOD FIT
MD, Loop & Lantern
Why now: team grew this year

Sequence for Maya Collins — LINED UP

DAY 1 · SENT
First email: Northwind's new account manager roles

DAY 3 · SCHEDULED
Follow-up: a short nudge with one example

DAY 7 · SCHEDULED
Last follow-up: closes the loop, politely

Your inbox — REPLIES

Maya Collins — INTERESTED
"Good timing, actually. Does Thursday at 2 work?"

Daniel Okafor — INTERESTED
"Can you send over pricing and a case study?"

Priya Nair — LATER
"Not this quarter, but try me again in January."

THE WORK	BY HAND	WITH THE AI SDR AGENT
Building the list	Evenings in spreadsheets and search tools	Fresh leads that fit, ready every morning
Researching each lead	10 to 15 minutes per lead to find, check and write an opener	A reason to talk now and why they fit, for every lead
Writing the emails	A template with a first name swapped in	One email per person, in your voice, about their business
Following up	The first thing to slip on a busy week	Every follow-up lined up and sent on time
Handling replies	Digging through threads and tabs	Replies land in the inbox you already use

Example leads and replies are illustrative. Manual times are typical estimates; your numbers will vary. Sending from your own mailbox is on paid plans.

COPY, FILL THE BRACKETS, SEND

7 message templates for every touch.

Short beats clever. Every template opens on them, gives something useful and makes one small ask.

01 · PUBLIC REPLY · PLAY A, DAY 0

[Direct answer to their question in 1 or 2 lines]. What worked for us/our clients: [one specific tip].

If it helps, happy to share [the checklist / setup / example] I use.

Answer first. The offer at the end is optional and soft.

02 · DM · PLAY A, DAY 1

Hey [name], saw your post in [place] about [problem]. I put together [the thing you mentioned]. Want me to send it over?

Mentions the exact post, so it never feels cold. One yes or no question.

03 · LINKEDIN CONNECTION NOTE

Hi [name], enjoyed your [post/comment] on [topic]. I work on [your area] with [type of company] and would like to follow your updates.

No pitch. The goal is to be a familiar name, not to sell in 200 characters.

04 · FIRST EMAIL · PLAY B, DAY 1

Subject: [their signal, in 3 to 5 words]

Hi [name], saw [signal: you're hiring two account managers]. Usually that means [the problem it creates].

We help [similar companies] [result] without [the usual cost or pain].

Worth a 15 minute chat next week?

Opens on why now. One line on you. One clear, small ask.

05 · FOLLOW-UP · PLAY B, DAY 3

Hi [name], one example in case it's useful: [similar company] used [your approach] to [specific result].

Happy to show you how it would look for [their company].

Adds proof, not pressure. Never "just bumping this".

06 · SOCIAL TOUCH · PLAY B, DAY 9

Hi [name], thanks for connecting. Curious how you're handling [problem] with the team growing. Anything you'd do differently?

A different angle from the emails. A question, not a repeat.

07 · LAST EMAIL · PLAY B, DAY 7

Hi [name], I'll stop here so I'm not cluttering your inbox. If [problem] moves up the list later, just reply to this email and I'll pick it straight up. Good luck with [their signal].

Closing the loop politely often gets the reply the first two didn't, and leaves the door open.

PRINT THIS PAGE

A weekly scorecard, and a checklist to keep your accounts safe.

Track five numbers per channel each week. After a month you will know which channel starts the most conversations for you, and where to put more effort.

THIS WEEK	EMAIL	LINKEDIN	REDDIT	X / THREADS	OTHER
Leads contacted					
Replies					
Positive replies					
Calls booked					
Reply rate (replies ÷ contacted)					

Also note which touch got the reply. If most replies come after the second or third touch, that is your multi-channel campaign doing its job.

EMAIL DELIVERABILITY CHECKLIST

So your emails land in the inbox

- [ ] SPF, DKIM and DMARC are set up on your sending domain
- [ ] You send from a real mailbox, under a real name
- [ ] New mailboxes start slowly and build volume over a few weeks
- [ ] First emails are plain text, with no attachments and no images
- [ ] One link at most, and none in the very first email if you can
- [ ] Every email opens on something specific to that person
- [ ] Bounced addresses are removed straight away
- [ ] Anyone who asks to stop is never emailed again
- [ ] You follow the email rules where your buyers are, such as GDPR in the UK and EU and CAN-SPAM in the US

SOCIAL SAFETY CHECKLIST

So your accounts stay in good standing

- [ ] You send replies and DMs yourself, from your own account
- [ ] No browser bots or tools that click for you on LinkedIn
- [ ] No copy and paste: each message is edited for the person
- [ ] You read the rules of every group and subreddit first
- [ ] Your profile says clearly who you are and what you do
- [ ] Your public replies help even if the person never buys
- [ ] You keep a sensible daily pace instead of bursts

This is why the social listening agent drafts and you send. Finding and writing are the slow parts; pressing send takes seconds and keeps your account yours.

TALK TO ME DATA

Let two agents run this playbook for you.

You now have the whole system: where buyers ask, the signals that say now, and the campaigns that turn them into conversations. The slow parts are the finding, the filtering, the writing and the following up. That is exactly what these two agents do, every day.



SOCIAL LISTENING AGENT

People asking for you, found every day

- ✓ Reads Reddit, X, Threads, YouTube, LinkedIn, Facebook and Instagram
- ✓ Skips self-promotion, vendors and job posts
- ✓ Rates every match and drafts a reply and a DM
- ✓ You send from your own account



AI SDR AGENT

Buyers who fit, written to and followed up

- ✓ Leads that match your ideal customer, every morning
- ✓ Spots hiring, funding, growth and launches
- ✓ A personal email and a full sequence for every lead
- ✓ Sends from your Gmail or Outlook on paid plans

Free to start

Every pre-built agent and 50 actions a month, free forever. No card required.

Get started →

app.talktomedata.com/signup · Or reply to the email this playbook came with and tell us who you sell to.